FREE HOBBY STARTER KIT

Letter-Writing Kit

For the grown-up · read this first, then hand over the stationery

This hobby's whole cost is one stamp — and you get to decide whether the kit even needs that, because a letter can be delivered by hand, slipped under a door, or tucked into a lunchbox. Everything else (paper, envelopes, something to write with) is already in the house. Receiving a real letter is such a rare event now that it reliably makes someone's entire week.

How to make the first letter land

- **Pick an easy recipient first:** a grandparent, a cousin, a friend who moved. The first letter is for practice, so choose someone who will definitely write back.
- **Ditch the "write something perfect" idea.** A letter about a rainy Tuesday, a lost tooth, or the lizard on the porch is exactly right. Three sentences count as a finished letter.
- **You write one too.** The grown-up writing a real letter at the same table is the demonstration that sells the hobby better than any instruction.
- **Address the envelope together.** Reading an address out loud, from bottom line up, is the one skill this kit quietly teaches.

> **Send-and-receive loop:** people write back when they get asked a question. "How was your garden this year?" guarantees a reply, and a reply turns one stamp into a conversation.

The no-gear rule

No wax seals, no fancy pens. Blank paper folded and taped works when envelopes run out; page 3 includes an envelope template you can trace on any sheet. One stamp buys science-fair-level excitement, but hand-delivery buys the same thrill for free.

Print page 2 for stationery, page 3 for the envelope template and spare stationery, page 4 to track the correspondence.

Stationery

This is a real sheet of stationery. Write today's date in the top box, choose your greeting, and let a letter happen below.

Date:		**To:**	

Gathering lines, in case the pen needs a push: I got your letter and… / The strangest thing happened today… / My question for you is…

Envelope & Refills

Cut the envelope below, fold on the dotted lines, glue the side flaps over the bottom flap. It fits the stationery pages (fold a letter in thirds).

Return address (from):
your own name and address, top-left corner

Stamp
goes here, top-right

Delivery address (to):
name
street, number
city, state, zip
Write big and straight — read it aloud yourself as a test.

When the envelope is sealed: draw a tiny picture or a border on the outside. Letters look like presents when decorated.

Spare stationery (print this page twice and copy it)

Date:		**To:**	

No-envelope trick: write the letter, fold it in half, fold again, write the address on one square folder face, tape the open edge, stamp it. Postal services accept these all the time — test it once with a letter to your own house so everyone sees the reply arrive.

Correspondence Log

One row per letter sent or received. The "reply?" column is the fun part: an empty box after a few weeks is the natural next letter to write.

DATE	SENT / GOT	WHO IT'S FROM / TO	WHAT IT WAS ABOUT (ONE LINE)	STAMP COST	REPLY?

People worth a letter

- ☐ Someone who talks about "the old days" at every visit
- ☐ A cousin exactly your age (compare the same week's weather)
- ☐ A teacher from a previous year
- ☐ Someone far away who has never seen our street
- ☐ A friend who moved (addresses stay findable through their grown-ups)
- ☐ Future us: a letter to open in one whole year

> **Reading mail is the hobby too:** establish one sacred rule now — incoming letters get read at the table, out loud or together, and each one earns its own row in the log above. A letter answered within a week keeps a pen pal alive for years.